

“Switching to Tizen doesn’t mean we are abandoning Android”

Samsung surely knows how to grab the eyeballs of techies and developers. After becoming a giant with Android, Samsung has now ventured into the world of wearable devices with the latest platform, Tizen. The company has worked to build Tizen up from scratch and has now introduced it to developers and the general public with its latest range of wearable devices including Gear 2, Gear 2 Neo and Gear Fit. Of course, the company is in no mood to give up on Android and is continuing to bank big on its Galaxy range of Android devices. Samsung Galaxy S5 is the latest entrant in the segment. With the company heavily investing in two of the biggest open source platforms, developers have loads of reasons to rejoice. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** caught up with **Manu Sharma, director, Mobile Business, Samsung Electronics (India)** about how the company plans to popularise Tizen, without ignoring Android. Read on...



Manu Sharma, director, Mobile Business, Samsung Electronics (India)

Q What are the five things that Samsung has concentrated on while designing the Galaxy S5?

Samsung's Galaxy S5 has a very simple-to-use and powerful camera. It has features like fast autofocus as well as the advanced High Dynamic Range (HDR) that reproduces natural light and colour with striking intensity at any occasion. It also has the selective focus feature, which allows users to focus on a specific area of an object while simultaneously blurring out the background. With this capability, consumers no longer need a special lens kit to create a shallow depth of field (DOF) effect.

The second most important thing that a modern day smartphone should have is speed. Samsung's Galaxy S5 comes with an octa-core processor, which is capable of operating all eight cores at the same time. This enables users to experience seamless multi-tasking.

Important feedback we got from users was that they want their devices to be protected. The Galaxy S5 is IP67 dust and water resistant. It also offers a finger scanner, providing a secure, biometric screen locking feature. The Ultra Power Saving Mode turns the display to black and white, and shuts down all unnecessary features to minimise battery power consumption.

Today, people are very health savvy and Samsung has ensured that the Galaxy S5 becomes their personal assistant, in that aspect. With the S Health 3.0, the new Galaxy S5 offers more tools to help people stay fit and well. It provides a comprehensive personal fitness tracker to help users monitor and manage their behaviour, along with additional tools including a pedometer, diet and exercise records, and a new, built-in heart rate sensor. Galaxy S5 users can further customise their experience with an enriched third party app ecosystem and the ability to sync with next generation Gear products for realtime fitness coaching.

Last but not the least is the design. The Galaxy S5 features a perforated pattern on the back cover creating a modern glamorous look.

Q You have chosen the Tizen platform for the Gear 2 smartwatch. Any reasons, in particular?

Samsung is looking at the broader ecosystem that will help devices interact with each other, as it also has a whole range of consumer electronics devices. Tizen can work with your refrigerator or TV set. That is one major reason why it was brought in. This has got nothing to do with Samsung abandoning Android, as is being said. Switching to Tizen